

JOHN GARCIA

ASSISTANT PROFESSOR OF FINANCE & ANALYTICS

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🌐 [LinkedIn](#)

SUMMARY

Assistant Professor of Finance & Analytics and former Toyota Corporate Finance Executive with a unique blend of high-level industry strategy and academic rigor. CPA and Certified Analytics Professional (CAP) with a track record of publishing in top-tier journals (Global Finance Journal, Review of Behavioral Finance). Expert in bridging the gap between theoretical finance and applied machine learning, consistently achieving top 1% teaching evaluations (Median 4.8/5.0) by bringing real-world executive insights into the classroom.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

- **Doctorate in Business Administration**, Finance & Analytics
CREIGHTON UNIVERSITY, 2020
Dissertation: *Measuring The Effect of Investor Sentiment on Liquidity and Financial Distress*
- **Master of Science in Predictive Analytics**
NORTHWESTERN UNIVERSITY, 2017
- **Master of Science in Accountancy**
UNIVERSITY OF NOTRE DAME, 2000
- **B.S. Business Administration**, Magna Cum Laude
CALIFORNIA POLYTECHNIC STATE UNIVERSITY, SLO, 1999
- **Certified Analytics Professional** (CAP, Lic#1509)
- **Certified Public Accountant** (CPA, CA Lic#81753, Inactive)
- **Associate in Captive Insurance** (ACI, Lic#291)
- **UNIVERSITY OF MICHIGAN**, Toyota Next Gen Executive Leadership Program, 2018

ACADEMIC EMPLOYMENT

CALIFORNIA LUTHERAN UNIVERSITY • School of Management • Thousand Oaks, CA

ASSISTANT PROFESSOR • Aug. 2021 – Present

- Develop and teach undergraduate and graduate finance, analytics, and data science courses
- Conduct innovative research at the intersection of finance, machine learning, and data analytics, resulting in multiple peer-reviewed publications and presentations at top-tier conferences
- Recipient of the 2023 School of Management Advisory Council award for outstanding research achievement.
- Developed 8 new courses: Business Analytics I & II, Machine Learning 1, Machine Learning in Practice, Introduction to Business (undergrad.) | Foundations of Analytics, Advanced Analytics, Innovations in FinTech (graduate)
- **Leadership & Service:**
 - Chair, Undergraduate Curriculum Committee (2025-current)
 - Selected for the CLU Emerging Leaders Program (2024-2025).
 - Faculty AI Task Force (May 2025 – present), charged with developing university-wide policies on the ethical and responsible use of AI in teaching, advising, tutoring, and academic integrity.
 - Faculty Chair for the Title V HSI Project VITAL faculty learning circle (2023 – 2025), advancing inclusive and culturally responsive student mentoring.
 - Faculty Senator (2022 – 2024), advising on academic policy and governance.
 - 2022-2023 Project Collaborative for Hispanics in Higher Education & Student Success (CHESS) Participant
 - Faculty Chair for Project CHESS 2023-2024, guiding faculty development and culturally responsive pedagogy
 - Co-developed a new undergraduate bachelor's degree in data science (launched in 2024), developing a comprehensive curriculum and two advanced machine learning courses aligned with industry standards.
- **Teaching Accomplishments:**
 - Track Record: Taught 48 courses since Fall 2021 and achieved an avg. and a mean rating of 4.7 and 5 out of 5.
 - Innovation: Created and deployed AI tutors accessed 1,000+ times monthly by students.
 - Graduate (MBA/MS) Courses: Advanced Analytics (ECON 562), Strategic Decision Making (EMBA 502), Foundations of Analytics (MBA 526), Strategic Financial Analysis (MBA 541), Corporate Finance (MBA 521), Innovations in FinTech (MBA 5STI), Foundations of Business Statistics (MBA 503).
 - Undergraduate Courses: Business Analytics I & II (BUS 256/356), Principles of Finance (BUS 391), Introduction to Business (BUS 151), Generative AI Literacy.

ACADEMIC EMPLOYMENT (CONTINUED)

UNIVERSITY OF NORTH TEXAS • Toulouse Graduate School • Denton, TX

CLINICAL ASSISTANT PROFESSOR • Jan. 2020 - Aug. 2021

- Taught and developed curriculum for M.S. in Advanced Data Analytics and Data Analytics Certificate programs, achieving high student satisfaction in in-person and online modalities.
- Research machine learning, finance, and data analytics.
- Supervised master's and Ph.D. student research projects, fostering emerging scholars in data analytics.
- Developed a guided project course on Coursera entitled "Predicting Credit Card Fraud with R."

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Fortitude Research and Marketing Consulting • Westlake Village, CA • August 2022 – December 2025

Senior Consultant (Contract)

- Provide strategic consulting, specializing in data analytics, advanced statistical modeling, and leveraging big data for predictive modeling, helping clients to make informed business decisions and strategic plans.

TOYOTA NORTH AMERICA • Plano, TX • Apr 2005- Jan 2020

EXECUTIVE - CORPORATE FINANCE ANALYTICS • 2018-2020

- A key corporate finance leadership team member providing comprehensive business and strategic insights into influencing high-stakes risk, pricing, and profitability decisions.
- Defined strategic direction of analytics projects and delivered critical and actionable financial insights and business analytics for strategic decision-making.
- Provided C-suite senior executive management with advice on the financial implications of business activities and recommendations to optimize performance.
- Defined and evaluated metrics to track risk, pricing, and profitability for the financial services division.
- Built, led, and developed a diverse team of data scientists, actuaries, and finance directors while working cross-functionally to enhance business outcomes and identify growth opportunities.
- Collaborated with stakeholders to leverage data and analytics to drive faster, optimal business decisions.
- Member of the cross-functional executive credit committee responsible for managing credit policy.

EXECUTIVE - PRICING & ANALYTICS • 2007-2018

SR. DIRECTOR, PRICING & ANALYTICS • 2011-2016 | MANAGER, PRICING & ANALYTICS • 2007-2010

- Delivered expert services, including developing pricing, underwriting, risk management, performance measurement, predictive analytics, financial and capital management strategies, and action plans.
- Worked with stakeholders to formulate pricing and incentive testing plans, measure and analyze A/B testing and multivariate tests and surveys, and develop statistical models.
- Guided and inspired a team of experienced finance, underwriting, actuarial, and analytics professionals.
- Interfaced with senior leadership and cross-organizational management to influence, obtain buy-in on performance optimization strategies, and support the execution of strategic action plans.
- Implemented a strategy to decentralize analytics and execute initiatives enabling enhanced consultative value. Optimized the existing business model and identified new U.S. and global business opportunities.

ASSISTANT CONTROLLER • 2005-2007

- Steered execution of financial planning, accounting, financial reporting, and tax optimization strategies.
- Developed asset-liability matching (ALM) strategies leading to more effective duration risk management.
- Chaired a cross-organizational team on the execution of the SOX compliance framework.
- Directed tax projects and compiled financial models that led to a favorable tax adjustment of \$1.7 billion, one of the largest tax adjustments in IRS history.
- Strategically anticipated and implemented numerous tax strategies leading to over \$50M in tax savings.
- Diligently developed a new process to mitigate bad debt expense and reduced bad debt by 90%+.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE (CONT'D)

ERNST & YOUNG LLP • Los Angeles, CA • 1999-2005 • MANAGER

- Adeptly planned, performed, and managed professional services for clients, primarily in the financial services industry.
- Developed problem-solving and financial analytical skills through drafting and reviewing financial statements. Researched complex SEC & GAAP technical accounting issues.
- Expertly performed analysis of company operations and internal controls while evaluating the effectiveness of current processes and recommending improvements.

RESEARCH AND TEACHING INTERESTS

Research Interests

- Applications of Advanced Analytics in Business
- Machine Learning and Artificial Intelligence
- Sentiment Analysis
- Behavioral Finance

Teaching Interests

- Corporate Finance & FinTech
- Business Analytics & Business Intelligence
- Data Analytics, Data Mining & Decision Science
- Applied Probability and Statistics

PUBLICATIONS, RESEARCH, AND PRESENTATIONS

Note: Authors are listed alphabetically in business disciplines, irrespective of their contributions.

Peer-Reviewed Journal Publications:

1. **Garcia, J.** & Lu-Andrews, R. (2026), "A Stabilizing Force? How Religiosity Moderates the Effect of Sentiment on Stock Liquidity." *Review of Behavioral Finance*. <https://doi.org/10.1108/RBF-08-2025-0325>
2. Garcia, J. (2025) "The Power of Attention: Examining The Roles of Institutional Investor and Macroeconomic News Attention In Shaping Share Liquidity." *Global Finance Journal*. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.gfj.2025.101160>
3. Garcia, J. (2025) "Beyond the Headlines: Sentiment Divergence and Financial Distress." *Global Finance Journal*. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.gfj.2025.101126>
4. Garcia, J. (2025) "Sentiment Divergence and its Impact on Share Liquidity." *Multinational Finance Journal*. <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.14957129>
5. Garcia, J. (2024) "Herding the Crowds: Effect of Sentiment on Crowdsourced Earnings Forecasts." *Financial Markets and Portfolio Management*. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11408-024-00447-4>
6. Dunham, L., **Garcia, J.**, Grandstaff J, Wei, S. (2023) "Do Employees Waive Financial Red Flags Through the Glassdoor?" *Journal of Forensic Accounting Research*, 1-28. <https://doi.org/10.2308/JFAR-2022-008>
Role: Methodology; Data analysis and interpretation; writing of the methodology, results, and conclusion.
7. Garcia, J. (2023), "Measuring Valuation Uncertainty: A PCA Approach". *Applied Finance Letters*, 12(1), 12-21. <https://doi.org/10.24135/afl.v12i1.605>
8. Garcia, J. (2022), "Analyst rating changes and the predictive value of news and Twitter sentiment." *Investment Analysts Journal*, 51(4), 236-252. <https://doi.org/10.1080/10293523.2022.2108651>
9. Garcia, J. (2022), "An evaluation of bankruptcy prediction algorithms using synthetic samples." *Machine Learning with Applications*, 9, 100343. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.mlwa.2022.100343>
10. Dunham, L., **Garcia J.** (2021), "Measuring the effect of investor sentiment on financial distress." *Managerial Finance*, 47(12), 1834-1852. <https://doi.org/10.1108/MF-02-2021-0056>. (Lead Author; dissertation research)
11. Garcia, J. (2021), "Analyst herding and investor sentiment." *Financial Markets and Portfolio Management*, 35(4), 461-494. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11408-021-00382-8>
12. Dunham, L., **Garcia, J.** (2021), "Measuring the effect of investor sentiment on liquidity," *Managerial Finance*, 47(1), 59-85. <https://doi.org/10.1108/MF-06-2019-0265>. (Lead Author; dissertation research)

Working Paper:

1. Garcia, J. "The Attention Economy of Retail Trading: Evidence from Robinhood and Social Media." [SSRN Link](#)
2. Garcia, J. "Algorithmic Anchoring: How Prompt-Embedded Reference Points Bias LLM Financial Estimates." [SSRN Link](#)
3. Garcia, J. "Homo Silicus is Hyper-Rational- Why LLM Agents Fail to Replicate Attention-Driven Trading." [SSRN Link](#)
4. Garcia, J., Bulut, L. "Measuring Firm-Level Valuation Uncertainty: A Comparative Study of ML, Ensembles, and LLMs."

PUBLICATIONS, RESEARCH, AND PRESENTATIONS (CONTINUED)

Conference Presentations and Proceedings (2021 to current):

- Garcia, J.** (2026). "Too Smart to be Human: Can AI Agents Replace Us in Behavioral Experiments?" *National Science Foundation (NSF) ACCESS Regional AI Workshop*, Los Angeles, CA.
- Garcia, J.** (2025). "The Attention Economy of Retail Trading: Evidence from Robinhood and Social Media." *Annual Meeting of the Financial Management Association*, Vancouver, Canada.
- Garcia, J.** (2025). "Decoding Social Media: How Attention and Sentiment Drive Retail Trading Behavior." *Research Symposium on Finance and Economics (RSFE)*, Virtual, Krea University, Sri City, India.
- Garcia, J.** (2025). "Market Buzz: The Impact of Social Media Sentiment and Attention On Robinhood Traders." *Western Decision Sciences Institute Annual Conference*, Honolulu, HI.
- Garcia, J.,** Lu-Andrews, R. (2025). "The Impact of Investor Sentiment on Share Liquidity: Examining the Roles of Religiosity and the COVID-19 Pandemic." *Western Decision Sciences Institute Annual Conference*, Honolulu, HI. (Presented by Lu-Andrews, R.)
- Garcia, J.** (2025). "Attention Matters: The Impact of Institutional Investor and Macroeconomic News Attention On Liquidity." *Southwestern Finance Association Annual Conference*, San Antonio, TX.
- Garcia, J.** (2025). "Market Buzz: The Impact of Social Media Sentiment and Attention On Robinhood Traders." *Southwestern Finance Association Annual Conference*, San Antonio, TX.
- Garcia, J.,** Lu-Andrews, R. (2025). "The Impact of Investor Sentiment on Share Liquidity: Examining the Roles of Religiosity and the COVID-19 Pandemic." *Southwestern Finance Association Annual Conference*, San Antonio, TX. (Presented by Lu-Andrews, R.)
- Garcia, J.** (2024). "The Power of Attention: Examining The Roles of Institutional Investor and Macroeconomic News Attention In Shaping Share Liquidity." *Annual Meeting of the Financial Management Association*, Dallas, TX.
- Garcia, J.** (2024). "The Power of Attention: Examining The Roles of Institutional Investor and Macroeconomic News Attention In Shaping Share Liquidity." *Annual Meeting of the Academy of Behavioral Finance & Economics*, Los Angeles, CA.
- Garcia, J.** (2024). "The Power of Attention: Examining The Roles of Institutional Investor and Macroeconomic News Attention In Shaping Share Liquidity." *Tenure Project Conference*, Marshall School of Business, Los Angeles, CA.
- Garcia, J.** (2024). "Catalyzing Financial Distress - The Impact of Divergent Sentiment and Excessive Attention?" *Southwestern Finance Association Annual Conference*, Las Vegas, NV.
- Garcia, J.** (2024). "The Impact of Investor Sentiment on Share Liquidity: Examining the Roles of Religiosity and the COVID-19 Pandemic." *Southwestern Finance Association Annual Conference*, Las Vegas, NV.
- Garcia, J.** (2023). "Divergent Investor Sentiment and Excessive Attention: A Catalyst for Financial Distress." *Financial Management Association Annual Meeting*, Chicago, IL.
- Garcia, J.** (2023). "Financial Distress - Unraveling the Impact of Divergent Investor Sentiment and Excess Attention." *Annual Meeting of the Academy of Behavioral Finance & Economics*, Woodland Hills, CA.
- Garcia, J.** (2023). "Liquidity in Flux: The Role of Sentiment Disagreement in Share Liquidity." *Research Symposium on Finance & Economics Conference*, Sri City, India (Virtual).
- Garcia, J.** (2023). "Sentiment Divergence and its Impact on Share Liquidity." *Financial Markets and Corporate Governance Conference*, Melbourne, Australia (Virtual).
- Garcia, J.** (2023). "Herding the Crowds: How Sentiment Affects Amateur Analysts' Earnings Estimates." *Southwestern Finance Association Annual Conference*, Houston, TX.
- Garcia, J.** (2023). "Measuring Valuation Uncertainty: A PCA Approach." *Southwest Decision Sciences Institute Annual Conference*, Houston, TX.
- Garcia, J.** (2022). "Do Employees Waive Financial Red Flags Through the Glassdoor?" *Southern Finance Association Annual Meeting*, Key West, FL.
- Garcia, J.** (2022). "Herding the Crowds." *Financial Markets and Corporate Governance Conference*, Virtual.
- Garcia, J.** (2022). "Bankruptcy Prediction Using Synthetic Sampling." *Southwestern Finance Association Annual Meeting*, New Orleans, LA.
- Garcia, J.** (2021). "Analyst Stock Ratings and the Predictive Value of News and Twitter Sentiment." *Financial Management Association Annual Meeting*, Denver, CO.
- Garcia, J.** (2021). "Analyst Rating Changes and the Predictive Value of News and Twitter Sentiment." *Southwestern Finance Association Annual Meeting*, Virtual.

TECHNICAL PROFICIENCY & FOREIGN LANGUAGE

- R, Python, JMP, SAS, Hyperion BI, Tableau, @Risk, STATA, SPSS, SQL, H2O, TensorFlow, Keras
- Fluent in Spanish

AWARDS AND RECOGNITION

- School of Management Advisory Council Award for Outstanding Research Achievement (2023)
- Financial Management Association Diversity Emerging Scholars Initiative Selection (2021, 2023, 2024, 2025)
- Outstanding Club Advisor Award Nomination (2024)
- International Appointment: Research Hub Contributor, The Artificial Intelligence in Education at Oxford University (AIEOU) (2024-Present).

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE – JOURNAL REVIEWER

Ad-hoc Journal Referee (2022-2026)

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| • Applied Economics Letters (Aug '24) | • Journal of Accounting and Public Policy (Nov '23, Dec '23) |
| • Applied Finance Letters (May '23) | • Journal of Economics and Finance (May '22, Dec '22) |
| • Cogent Business & Management (May '25) | • Journal of Financial Econometrics (Jan '26) |
| • Expert Systems With Applications (July '22) | • Journal of International Financial Markets, Institutions, and Money (May '24, Sept '24, Nov '24) |
| • Financial Markets & Portfolio Management (Apr '22) | • Journal of Supercomputing (Nov '24) |
| • Global Finance Journal (Oct '23, Mar '25, May '25, Oct '25) | • Managerial Finance (Feb '22, June '24) |
| • Humanities & Social Sciences Communication (Oct '25, Mar '26) | • Review of Behavioral Finance (Jan '26) |
| • International Journal of Sports Finance (July '25) | |

UNIVERSITY SERVICE

University Leadership & Governance

- **Chair, Undergraduate Curriculum Committee** (2025 – Present). Elected position overseeing academic standards and curriculum updates.
- **Faculty AI Task Force** (2025 – Present). Charged with developing university-wide policies on the ethical and responsible use of AI in teaching and academic integrity.
- **Faculty Senator** (2022 – 2024). Advised on academic policy and governance.
- **Curriculum Developer, Data Science Major** (2023). Co-developed the framework for a new Bachelor of Science degree, creating comprehensive curriculum and two advanced machine learning courses.
- **Faculty Co-Chair, Project VITAL & Project CHESS** (2023 – Present). Leading faculty learning circles to advance inclusive, culturally responsive pedagogy and student mentoring.
- **Committee Member:** Faculty Diversity, Equity, & Inclusion Committee (2022 – 2023); SOM DEIJ Steering Committee (2021 – 2024).

Student Success & Mentorship

- **Faculty Advisor:** LatinX Business Student Association (2023 – Present); Beta Gamma Sigma International Business Honor Society (2023 – Present).
- **Research Mentor:** McNair Scholars Program; Supervised Master's/PhD research projects at UNT.
- **Event Moderator:** Organized and moderated multiple alumni panels, including "Overcoming Barriers & Navigating Success" (2023) and "Managing Yourself Through Change" (2022).

University Committee & Student Advising

- Faculty Advisor, LatinX Business Student Association (Fall 2023–present)
- Faculty Advisor, Beta Gamma Sigma, International Business Honor Society (Spring 2023-present)
- Advisory Member, Ethnic Race Studies (Fall 2022–present)
- Committee Member, Faculty Diversity, Equity, & Inclusion Committee (Fall 2022-Fall 2023)
- Partner, University Admissions, Personal Postcard Initiative to Drive Enrollment (May 5, 2022)

Community Engagement

- **Board Member & Treasurer, Westminster Free Clinic** (2025 – Present). Treasurer & chair of the Audit Committee. Apply financial expertise to ensure fiscal sustainability for a clinic serving 15,000+ uninsured patients with a \$5M+ operating budget.

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

- Prospanica: Center for Social Justice – Thought Leadership Committee (2021 - 2024)
- INFORMS: DFW Chapter President (2021)
- Prospanica: DFW Chapter VP Education (2021)
- Finance Management Association

DEVELOPMENT ACTIVITIES (2021-CURRENT)

- Conference, "Financial Management Association Annual Meeting," Vancouver, Canada (October 22-25, 2025).
- Professional Development, Faculty-Led Travel Seminar Workshop series, CLU (2024-2025)
- Conference, "Research Symposium on Finance and Economics (RSFE) 2025", Virtual, Krea University, Sri City, India (June 11-13, 2025)
- Conference, "Western Decision Sciences Institute Annual Meeting," Honolulu, HI. (April 8-11, 2025).
- Conference, "Southwestern Finance Association Annual Meeting," San Antonio, TX. (February 12-February 15, 2025).
- Conference, "Financial Management Association Annual Meeting," Dallas, TX (October 16-19, 2024).
- Workshop, "Financial Management Association Diversity Emerging Scholars Initiative," Financial Management Association, Dallas, TX. (October 15, 2024).
- Conference, Annual Meeting of the Academy of Behavioral Finance & Economics, LA, CA (Sept. 18 – Sept. 20, 2024).
- Conference, "Tenure Project Conference," Marshall School of Business, Los Angeles, CA (July 21-24, 2024).
- Conference, "Southwestern Finance Association Annual Meeting," Las Vegas, NV. (February 28-March 2, 2024).
- Conference, "Financial Management Association Annual Meeting," Chicago, IL. (October 11-14, 2023).
- Workshop, "Financial Management Association Diversity Emerging Scholars Initiative," Financial Management Association, Denver, CO. (October 10, 2023).
- Conference, Academy of Behavioral Finance & Economics Annual Meeting, Woodland Hills, CA (Sep. 21-22, 2023)
- Conference "Tenure Project Conference," Wharton School of Business, Philadelphia, PA (July 24-26, 2023)
- Conference, Research Symposium on Finance & Economics Conference, Sri City, India, Virtual (June 14-16, 2023)
- Conference, Financial Markets and Corporate Governance Conference, Melbourne, AUS, Virtual (April 11 – 13, 2023)
- Conference, "Southwestern Finance Association Annual Meeting," Houston, TX. (March 8-11, 2023).
- Conference, "Southwest DSI Annual Meeting," Houston, TX. (March 8-11, 2023).
- Collaborative for Hispanics in Higher Education & Student Success (Project CHESS), Faculty Learning Circle, CLU, Thousand Oaks, CA (Jan. 4, 2023)
- Conference, "Southern Finance Association Annual Meeting," Key West, FL. (November 16-19, 2022).
- Conference "Tenure Project Conference," Seattle, WA (August 1-4, 2022)
- Collaborative for Hispanics in Higher Education & Student Success (Project CHESS), Faculty Learning Circle, CLU, Thousand Oaks, CA (June 1-3)
- Conference, "Hong Kong Conference for Fintech, AI, and Big Data in Business," Virtual May 27-28, 2022,.
- CLU Junior Faculty Retreat CLU, Thousand Oaks, CA (May 18-20, 2022).
- Conference, "Financial Markets and Corporate Governance Conference," Virtual. (April 20-22, 2022).
- Conference (Session Chair), "Southwestern Finance Association Annual Meeting, New Orleans, LA (March 2–5, 2022).
- CLU Faculty Development Lunch Series (October – November 2021)
- Conference, "Financial Management Association Annual Meeting," Denver, CO. (October 19-23, 2021).
- Workshop, "Financial Management Association Diversity Emerging Scholars Initiative," Financial Management Association, Denver, CO. (October 18-19, 2021).
- Conference, "Northeast Decision Sciences Institute Annual Meeting," Online Conference. (March 26-27, 2021).
- Conference, "Southwestern Finance Association Annual Meeting," Online Conference. (March 18-19, 2021).
- Conference, "Human Rights and Data Science Conference," Southern Methodist University Data Science Institute, Online Conference. (February 25-26, 2021).
- Conference, "RStudio Global 2021," R Studio, Online Conference. (Jan. 21, 2021).
- Conference, "American Finance Association Annual Meeting," American Finance Association, Online Conference. (Jan. 3, 2021 –Jan. 5, 2021).